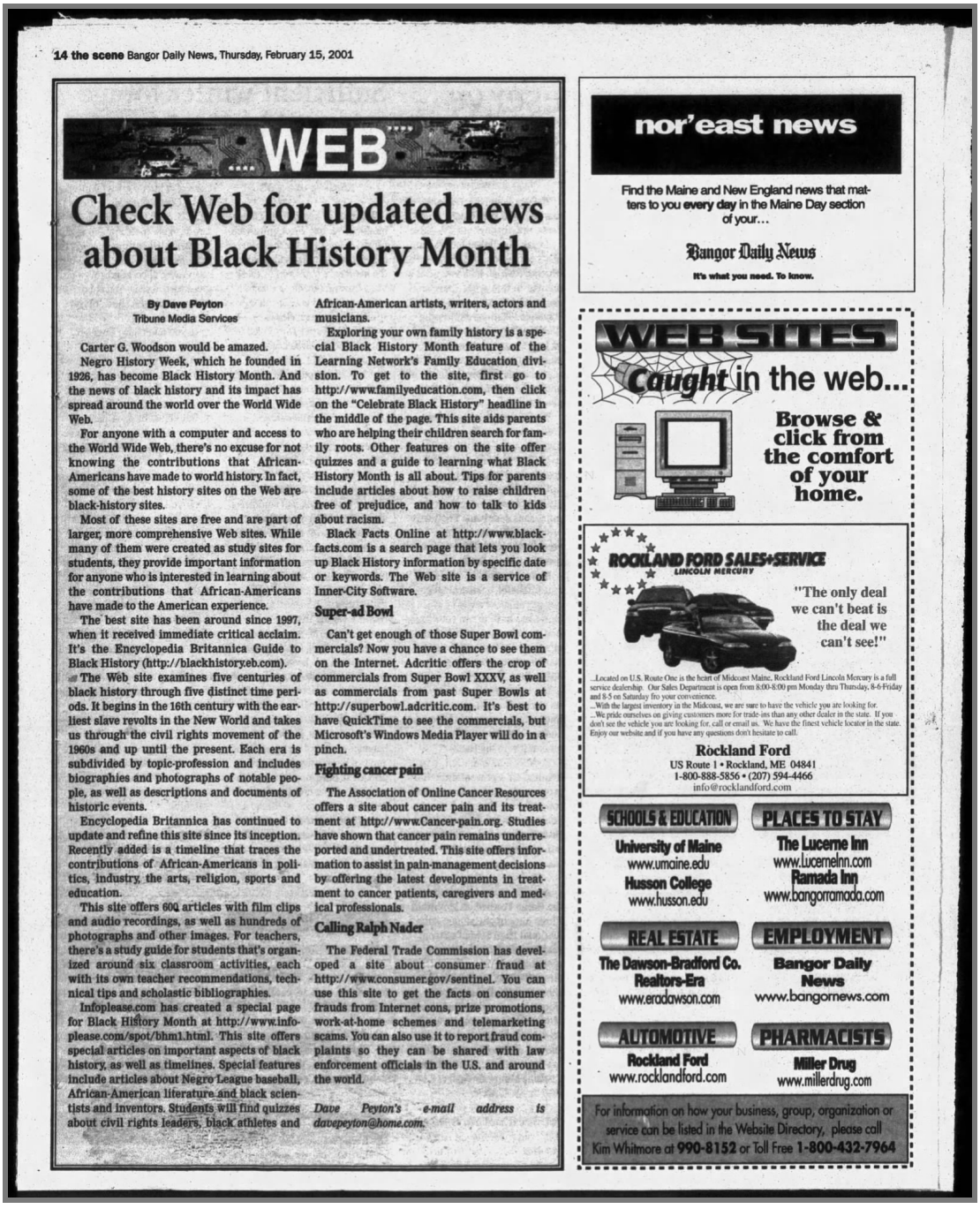
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WEB

Check Web for updated news about Black History Month

By Dave Peyton
Tribune Media Services

Carter G. Woodson would be amazed.

Negro History Week, which he founded in 1926, has become Black History Month. And the news of black history and its impact has spread around the world over the World Wide Web.

For anyone with a computer and access to the World Wide Web, there's no excuse for not knowing the contributions that African-Americans have made to world history. In fact, some of the best history sites on the Web are black-history sites.

Most of these sites are free and are part of larger, more comprehensive Web sites. While many of them were created as study sites for students, they provide important information for anyone who is interested in learning about the contributions that African-Americans have made to the American experience.

The best site has been around since 1997, when it received immediate critical acclaim. It's the Encyclopedia Britannica Guide to Black History (http://blackhistory.eb.com).

The Web site examines five centuries of black history through five distinct time periods. It begins in the 16th century with the earliest slave revolts in the New World and takes us through the civil rights movement of the 1960s and up until the present. Each era is subdivided by topic-profession and includes biographies and photographs of notable people, as well as descriptions and documents of historic events.

Encyclopedia Britannica has continued to update and refine this site since its inception. Recently added is a timeline that traces the contributions of African-Americans in politics, industry, the arts, religion, sports and education.

This site offers 600 articles with film clips and audio recordings, as well as hundreds of photographs and other images. For teachers, there's a study guide for students that's organized around six classroom activities, each with its own teacher recommendations, technical tips and scholastic bibliographies.

Infoplease.com has created a special page for Black History Month at http://www.infoplease.com/spot/bhm1.html. This site offers special articles on important aspects of black history, as well as timelines. Special features include articles about Negro League baseball, African-American literature and black scientists and inventors. Students will find quizzes about civil rights leaders, black athletes and African-American artists, writers, actors and musicians.

Exploring your own family history is a special Black History Month feature of the Learning Network's Family Education division. To get to the site, first go to http://www.familyeducation.com, then click on the "Celebrate Black History" headline in the middle of the page. This site aids parents who are helping their children search for family roots. Other features on the site offer quizzes and a guide to learning what Black History Month is all about. Tips for parents include articles about how to raise children free of prejudice, and how to talk to kids about racism.

Black Facts Online at http://www.blackfacts.com is a search page that lets you look up Black History information by specific date or keywords. The Web site is a service of Inner-City Software.

Super-ad Bowl

Can't get enough of those Super Bowl commercials? Now you have a chance to see them on the Internet. Adcritic offers the crop of commercials from Super Bowl XXXV, as well as commercials from past Super Bowls at http://superbowl.adcritic.com. It's best to have QuickTime to see the commercials, but Microsoft's Windows Media Player will do in a pinch.

Fighting cancer pain

The Association of Online Cancer Resources offers a site about cancer pain and its treatment at http://www.Cancer-pain.org. Studies have shown that cancer pain remains underreported and undertreated. This site offers information to assist in pain-management decisions by offering the latest developments in treatment to cancer patients, caregivers and medical professionals.

Calling Ralph Nader

The Federal Trade Commission has developed a site about consumer fraud at http://www.consumer.gov/sentinel. You can use this site to get the facts on consumer frauds from Internet cons, prize promotions, work-at-home schemes and telemarketing scams. You can also use it to report fraud complaints so they can be shared with law enforcement officials in the U.S. and around the world.

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